VOL. I · NO. 7
TUESDAY EDITION

MUMBAI
EDITED FOR SHARVIN SHAH

# The Jarvis Gazette

All the world, before your coffee.

TUESDAY - NOVEMBER 10, 2026 | MUMBAI, INDIA | EDITION NO. 7

## ₹ Indian Money

STOCK MARKET · GOLD & SILVER · YOUR WALLET

| SENSEX · MON CLOSE | NIFTY 50 · MON CLOSE | PSU BANKS · MON | RUPEE · PER $ | GOLD · 24K MUMBAI |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 81,107 | 25,045 | +3.7% | ₹93.93 | ₹1,44,600 |
| ▲ 0.13% | ▲ 0.23% | best sector | Monday close | per 10 g, Mon |

THE BIG STORY · A HOLIDAY PAUSE

# Markets shut today for Balipratipada, after a small gain that kept the Sensex at its best level since February

*Government-owned banks rescued a shaky Monday. The Sensex and Nifty edged up, but more shares fell than rose, and technology companies slipped.*

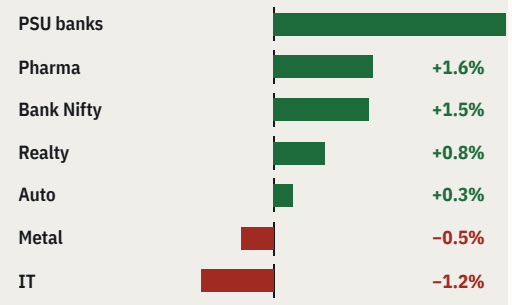
Monday began with a wobble: shares fell steeply in the morning before buyers stepped in. By the close the Sensex was at **81,106.65**, up 107 points (0.13%), and the Nifty at **25,044.65**, up 58 points (0.23%). Both are their **highest closing levels since 27 February**, HDFC Sky reports. The Nifty had already gained about 10.5% over the seven sessions before Monday, so a small step is a healthy pause, not a stumble.

The heroes were **public-sector banks**, the ones the government owns. Their index jumped **3.7%**, with Union Bank up 5.6%, PNB up 5.3% and Bank of Baroda up 4.5%. State Bank of India rose 2.56%, the best among the Nifty's 50 shares. Drug-makers did well too (pharma +1.6%). On the other side, **IT** companies fell 1.2% (Infosys −1.5%), and Tata Steel was the Nifty's worst share, down 2.81%, on the day it reported results.

**Today is a holiday.** The NSE and BSE are closed for Diwali Balipratipada, and trading resumes on **Wednesday 11 November**. By then the market will have to digest a big jump on Wall Street on Monday, cheaper oil, and America's inflation figures tonight (page 2).

**Watch this:** foreign investors have bought more than **$4.1 billion** of Indian shares so far this month, the strongest monthly inflow since September 2024, HDFC Sky says. But breadth was weak again: 2,316 shares fell and only 1,922 rose on the NSE.

### ⓘ MONDAY'S SECTOR MOVES




13 of 16 big sector indices ended higher.

### MONDAY'S BEST AND WORST (NIFTY)

- ▲ SBI **+2.56%** · Trent +2.02%
- ▲ Nestlé India +1.91% · NTPC +1.87%
- ▼ Tata Steel **−2.81%** · HCL Tech −2.43%
- ▼ UltraTech −1.79% · ITC −1.64%

### ⓘ NEW TO THIS? WORDS FROM TODAY'S STORY

**PSU bank**
A public-sector bank, mostly owned by the government, like SBI, PNB or Bank of Baroda.

**FPI / FII**
Foreign investors (funds from abroad) who buy Indian shares. Their buying often pushes the market up.

**Breadth**
How many shares rose versus fell. Index up but most shares down means a "narrow" market.

**India VIX**
India's "fear gauge": how big a swing traders expect. It fell 5.8% on Monday, a calmer mood.

### WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOU

Gold climbed again on Monday: 24-carat gold in Mumbai was about **₹1,44,600** per 10 g, up ₹1,140 from Friday (Goodreturns via HDFC Sky), and MCX gold futures settled near ₹1,43,540. Silver futures rose 1.1% to ₹1,87,170 per kg. The rupee ended near **₹93.93** to the dollar. A weak rupee makes imports like phones, foreign trips and gold costlier, so plan big foreign purchases with a little extra margin.

### VARSITY-STYLE EXPLAINER: WHY DID GOVERNMENT BANKS JUMP?

Bank shares rise when investors expect more loans and fewer bad loans. PSU banks are cheaper than private ones compared with their profits, so when the mood is good, bargain-hunters often rush to them first. That's why a single day can see a 5% jump in a big, old bank.

BUSINESS BRIEFS

RESULTS
### Tata Steel profit up 16%

September-quarter profit rose to ₹3,700 crore on revenue of ₹65,436 crore, Kotak Neo reports, but losses in the UK weighed and the shares fell.

ORDERS
### L&T builds Noida Metro

L&T won a "significant" order (₹1,000–2,500 crore) to build a 15.1 km elevated stretch with 10 stations for the Noida Metro Aqua Line, in 36 months.

PHARMA
### Morepen goes to America

Morepen Labs launched its first US prescription generic, an allergy tablet, and its shares closed up 5%, HDFC Sky reports.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

### Shape tomorrow's paper

Scan with your phone camera to rate today's edition and tell the editor what you want more or less of. Tomorrow's paper reads your answers before it is written.

Or tap here to open the feedback desk

Sources: HDFC Sky close report, 9 Nov (closes, breadth, VIX, FPI, holiday) · HDFC Sky sector snapshot · HDFC Sky gainers and losers · Kotak Neo closing bell (MCX gold, silver) · HDFC Sky / Goodreturns (gold rate) · HDFC Sky / PTI (rupee) · Kotak Neo (Tata Steel) · HDFC Sky (L&T) · HDFC Sky (Morepen). Explainers draw on Zerodha Varsity. Not investment advice.

# World Money

WHERE THE WORLD'S MARKETS STAND · TONIGHT'S BIG NUMBER

THE BIG STORY · PEACE HOPES

## Talk of an end to the Iran war sends oil down and shares soaring around the world

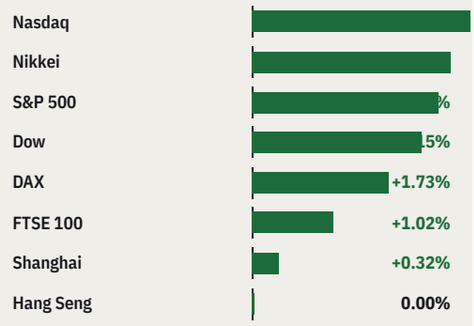
*Wall Street had its best day in months on Monday. Oil slid towards $92 a barrel, and a measure of investor fear fell by more than a fifth.*

Monday was a sea of green. In New York the **S&P 500**, a basket of America's 500 biggest companies, jumped **2.35%** to 7,549.94, the **Dow** rose 2.15% to 52,389.75 and the tech-heavy **Nasdaq** gained 2.74%, Yahoo Finance shows. Tokyo's Nikkei climbed 2.48% to above **60,000** for the first time in our pages, and London and Frankfurt rose too.

The reason was the war in the Gulf. On Sunday President Trump told CNN he was "highly unlikely" to order new attacks on Iran while talks continue, and he says he expects to meet China's Xi Jinping and Russia's Vladimir Putin in Shenzhen next week (page 3). Rio Times says oil fell on talk of an end to the war. Brent crude, the world's benchmark oil price, traded near **$92**, against $98 on Friday. Sources disagree on Monday's exact drop (Yahoo shows a small one by its contract), but every source puts Brent well below last week's levels; it fell 16% last week alone, AND Magazine notes.

**Tonight's test:** America publishes its October **inflation** figures at **7 PM India time**. Economists expect prices to have risen 3.7% from a year earlier, and "core" prices (leaving out food and fuel) 2.5%, Rio Times reports. A hot number would raise the odds of a US interest-rate *rise* in December; betting markets already put that at about 77%.

### WORLD SCOREBOARD · MONDAY




Monday's closes, from Yahoo Finance. South Korea's KOSPI led Asia, up 4.72%, Rio Times says.

### THE FEAR GAUGE




The VIX measures how much big swings investors expect. It fell 22% on Monday.

### WHY SHOULD SOMEONE IN MUMBAI CARE?

India buys most of its oil from abroad, so cheaper oil is good news twice over: it can ease petrol and diesel costs over time, and it helps the rupee because India spends fewer dollars. Indian markets are shut today for Balipratipada (page 1), so Monday's global cheer and tonight's US inflation number will both land on Dalal Street together on Wednesday morning.

### JARGON BUSTER

**S&P 500**
An index of 500 large US companies. Think of it as America's Nifty, only bigger.

**Brent crude**
Oil from the North Sea used as the world's price tag for crude. India's import costs follow it closely.

**CPI**
Consumer price index: the cost of a typical shopping basket. Its yearly rise is "inflation".

**Rate hike**
When a central bank raises interest rates to cool prices. Loans get dearer and shares often fall.

GOLD & CRYPTO

### Gold near $4,140, Bitcoin flat

Gold futures rose about 0.7% to $4,141.50 an ounce on Yahoo's figures (Rio Times shows a bigger rise). Bitcoin sat near $74,995, almost unchanged.

GAMES

### The GTA VI countdown

Take-Two, maker of Grand Theft Auto, reported results after Monday's US close; its new GTA VI is due on 19 November, StockTitan notes. We'll bring you the numbers tomorrow.

THIS WEEK

### AI and chips on deck

AI cloud firm CoreWeave reports tonight; Cisco and Applied Materials follow on Thursday. Nvidia and Disney report next Tuesday, 17 November.

Sources: Yahoo Finance markets (Monday closes, oil, gold, VIX, Bitcoin, 10-year yield 4.86%) · Rio Times global briefing and live board (oil story, CPI forecasts, Fed odds, KOSPI) · StockTitan earnings calendar (Take-Two, CoreWeave, Cisco) · AND Magazine morning brief (Brent weekly fall) · Just Security (Trump CNN remarks). Oil figures differ between sources. Not investment advice.

# World Affairs

WHO'S DOING WHAT, AND WHY IT MATTERS

THE BIG STORY · THREE BIG MEN, ONE ROOM?

## Trump says he will meet Xi and Putin together in China next week, to talk about ending the Iran war and nuclear weapons

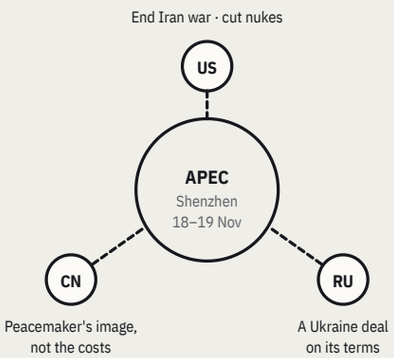
*If it happens, it would be a rare three-way meeting of the leaders of the US, China and Russia, at the APEC summit in Shenzhen on 18–19 November.*

"One of the meetings I think will be with President Putin and President Xi, and that'll be interesting," Donald Trump said, according to Euronews. He wants to discuss "denuclearization", meaning cutting nuclear weapons, and ending the war with Iran. Beijing said on Monday it is "in communication with relevant parties". The Kremlin had said back on 21 October that a three-way meeting was "being prepared".

Experts are cautious. "China wants the image but not the costs," analyst Sun Yun of the Stimson Center told Euronews; another analyst, Craig Singleton, said it may be "no more than a photo opportunity". A Wall Street Journal report says Putin hopes to use the talks to push a Ukraine deal on Moscow's terms. No promises on weapons, Ukraine or Iran have been announced.

**Meanwhile on Iran:** Trump said he was "highly unlikely" to order new attacks while talks progress, and met Qatar's prime minister at the White House on Monday. But the sides are far apart. Secretary of State Marco Rubio called Iran's offer "outrageous", while Iran's foreign ministry calls it the most reasonable plan on the table and demands that sanctions and the US blockade be lifted *before* talks begin, Just Security reports.

### WHO WANTS WHAT IN SHENZHEN




Goals as described by analysts and reports quoted by Euronews.

### THE INDIA ANGLE

India has the most to gain from a quiet Gulf. Most of its crude oil comes from abroad, much of it through the Strait of Hormuz, so every hint of peace lowers the oil bill (Brent fell towards $92 on Monday, page 2). A US–China–Russia meeting also matters to New Delhi, which buys Russian oil, trades heavily with China and is close to Washington: India gains when the big three talk rather than fight. None of the reports we read mentioned an Indian role in the Shenzhen talks.

### THE IRAN STAND-OFF IN TWO LINES

| US wants | Iran wants | Result |
|---|---|---|
| Hormuz reopened first, then nuclear talks | sanctions and blockade lifted first | talks about talks, while ships wait |

A phased US offer has been reported but not confirmed.

AROUND THE WORLD

UKRAINE

### The power-grid war

Russia says it hit four Ukrainian electricity substations; Ukraine hit another Russian oil refinery. US-mediated talks in Abu Dhabi are expected this week, and France says it will attend.

Why it matters: winter makes power a weapon.

ISRAEL

### Eisenkot gets a turn

President Isaac Herzog asked former army chief Gadi Eisenkot to try to form a government. He has 28 days, Axios reports via Just Security.

Why it matters: a new leader could change Gaza policy.

EUROPE

### Mourning in Kraków

A gunman killed six people and wounded 15 in the Polish city's central square. Poland declared two days of national mourning, AP reports.

Why it matters: political violence is rising in Europe.

Sources: Euronews (Trump–Xi–Putin, analysts, Kremlin) · Just Security Early Edition, 9 Nov (Iran, Rubio, Ukraine, Israel, Poland; citing AP, Reuters, Axios, WSJ) · AND Magazine morning brief (Beijing response, phased offer, Brent) · YourNews. The three-way meeting is not yet confirmed by Beijing or Moscow.

# Defence

ARMY · NAVY · AIR FORCE · MADE IN INDIA

AIR FORCE THE BIG STORY

## The "Gajraj" lands on the roof of the world: an IAF IL-76 touches down at 13,629 feet in Ladakh

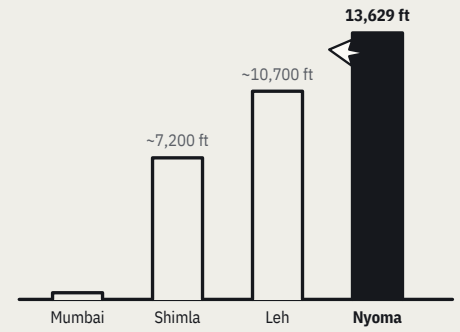
*The Air Force's giant transport plane landed at Nyoma in eastern Ladakh, a feat Defence Standard describes as a record for so heavy an aircraft at that height.*

The **IL-76MD**, nicknamed *Gajraj* (king of elephants) in the Indian Air Force, is a four-engine Russian-designed freighter that can carry tanks, trucks and troops. On Sunday it landed at **Nyoma**, an airfield in eastern Ladakh, at **13,629 feet** above sea level, Defence Standard reports. The site calls it a world record for the heaviest transport aircraft at that height; we could not confirm the record claim independently.

Why is it hard? At that height the air is thin. Wings get less lift and engines get less oxygen, so a plane must land faster and needs a longer runway to stop. Carrying heavy loads makes it harder still. Nyoma sits close to the Line of Actual Control with China, so being able to land big planes there means soldiers, fuel and equipment can reach the border in hours instead of days by road.

**Also from the mountains:** Defence Minister Rajnath Singh spent Diwali with soldiers of the **Trishakti Corps** in forward areas of Sikkim and paid tribute at the Sherathang War Memorial near Nathu La, PTI reports. Earlier he urged troops at Sukna and airmen at Bagdogra to prepare for cyber and drone threats.

### HOW HIGH IS 13,629 FEET?




Shimla and Leh heights are approximate.

### NAVY MALABAR 2026 AT A GLANCE

- India · US · Japan · Australia
- Hosted in Japan
- 30 years of Malabar
- INS Sahyadri at Yokosuka

DRDO · MISSILES

### Pralay passes its exam

DRDO says its home-made Pralay missile met all objectives in a user evaluation trial off the Odisha coast, a step towards entering service, Defence Standard reports.

NAVY EXERCISE

### Quad navies sail together

India, the US, Japan and Australia began Malabar 2026 in Japan: the exercise's 30th year and the sixth with all four nations.

EXPORTS

### Manila wants more BrahMos

The Philippines is eyeing more BrahMos missiles and has shared a shopping list with India, IANS reports. No new contract has been signed.

### ⓘ DEFENCE WORDS DECODED

**Quasi-ballistic**
A missile that flies a rocket's arc but can change course mid-flight, so it's harder to shoot down.

**User trial**
The tests the armed forces themselves run before agreeing to buy a weapon.

**LAC**
Line of Actual Control: the de facto border between India and China.

**HADR**
Humanitarian assistance and disaster relief: using the forces to help after floods or quakes.

NEIGHBOURS

### Rahat Mitra wraps up

India and Myanmar concluded their first tri-services disaster relief exercise, Rahat Mitra, in Chennai, PIB says.

ARMY FACT CHECK

### "False," says the Army

The Army dismissed social-media claims of Chinese advances in Arunachal Pradesh as false, Defence Standard reports.

Sources: Defence Standard (IL-76 at Nyoma) · idrw.org / PTI (Rajnath in Sikkim) · Defence Standard (Sukna) · Defence Standard (Pralay) · Defence Standard (Malabar) · SSBCrack (INS Sahyadri) · idrw.org / IANS (BrahMos) · idrw.org / PIB (Rahat Mitra) · Defence Standard (Army rebuttal). Several items rest on a single report.

# Sports

CRICKET · FORMULA 1 · FOOTBALL

CRICKET · 3RD ODI · SEDDON PARK, HAMILTON

## India chase a series win in New Zealand as you read this

*Two up with three to play, India began the third one-day international at 7:30 this morning. One more win and the five-match series is theirs.*

India have won both ODIs so far, and both were decided by the rain rules.

In the first, on 4 November, they bowled New Zealand out for 185 and won by five wickets under the **DLS method** (a formula that resets targets when rain shortens a match). In the second, on Saturday, it was even tighter: New Zealand made 134, India were 113 for 7 after 26 overs when rain came, and the formula gave India the win by just **four runs**, SportzCraazy's records show.

The third match started at **7:30 AM IST** today at Seddon Park, so the result will arrive after this paper goes to press. Players to watch: New Zealand's **Glenn Phillips**, the tour's top run-scorer with 371 runs, and fast bowler **Jacob Duffy**, with 11 wickets; for India, left-arm quick **Arshdeep Singh** has 10 wickets on tour. Games four and five follow on Friday 13 and Sunday 15 November, and then come two Tests, from 19 and 27 November.

**Formula 1 catch-up:** after Sunday's Brazilian Grand Prix, Mercedes' 20-year-old **Kimi Antonelli** is champion, as we reported yesterday, on 390 points, PlanetF1's standings show. The season's next stop is the **Las Vegas Grand Prix**: the race starts at 4 AM IST on Sunday 22 November.

ODI SERIES · AFTER 2 OF 5

| | |
|---|---|
| IND | 2 |
| NZ | 0 |

3RD ODI: LIVE THIS MORNING, HAMILTON

### HOW INDIA WON THE FIRST TWO

**1st ODI** · NZ 185 · IND 143/5 · won (DLS)
**2nd ODI** · NZ 134 · IND 113/7 · won by 4 runs (DLS)

Both matches were shortened by rain.

### F1 DRIVERS' TABLE · TOP 5

| | |
|---|---|
| Antonelli | 390 |
| Verstappen | 279 |
| Russell | 262 |
| Hamilton | 261 |
| Leclerc | 249 |

From PlanetF1; three races remain.

### FOOTBALL · AROUND THE GROUNDS

**Premier League** · Sunderland **1–0** Chelsea
**Premier League** · Crystal Palace **1–3** Liverpool
**Premier League** · Man Utd **4–4** Aston Villa
**SAFF Championship** · Maldives **0–3** Pakistan
**SAFF Championship** · Sri Lanka **2–2** Bhutan

**Next for India:** v Maldives, SAFF, Wed 11 Nov, 3 PM IST

WOMEN'S CRICKET

### Mandhana to lead in South Africa

Smriti Mandhana has been named captain for India women's tour of South Africa in December, covering Tests, ODIs and T20s, SportzCraazy reports.

RANJI TROPHY

### 834 runs in five innings

Mizoram's Chinmay Sutar leads the Ranji run charts with 834 runs; Vidarbha's Harsh Dubey leads the bowlers with 28 wickets. Mumbai beat Railways by 106 runs.

F1 · NEXT RACE

### Las Vegas under the lights

The Las Vegas Grand Prix runs 20–22 November on the city's famous Strip, followed by Qatar and the Abu Dhabi finale.

Sources: SportzCraazy (India tour of New Zealand: fixtures, results, top performers) · SportzCraazy Morning Pulse, 9 Nov (football results) · SportzCraazy (Ranji Trophy) · SportzCraazy (Mandhana, SAFF) · PlanetF1 (standings) · PlanetF1 (Brazil result, Las Vegas schedule). ESPNcricinfo was unavailable at press time; F1 standings are taken from PlanetF1's summary table.

# The Reading Room

THREE PIECES OF GREAT WRITING, AND WHAT TO LEARN FROM THEM

*A holiday-morning menu: why so many young professionals feel let down, what your mind drifts to in the shower, and the Varsity chapter that finally explains what the Sensex actually is.*

## 01

LIFE · HAPPINESS | 15 MIN READ

### "Why Generation Y Yuppies Are Unhappy" by Tim Urban, Wait But Why

**In one line:** happiness is roughly reality minus expectations, and many of us were raised with expectations sky-high.

Tim Urban invents a character called Lucy, a young professional who was told she was special, expected a career like a beautiful flower garden, and is now quietly disappointed. Through cartoons and simple graphs he explains why: her parents expected a decent, steady life and got one; Lucy expected something extraordinary, and comparing herself with friends' highlight reels online makes her feel even further behind. It's funny, short by Wait But Why standards, and has a kind ending: stay ambitious, but stop assuming you're owed the garden.

**STEAL THIS TRICK**

**Turn an idea into a formula.** "Happiness = Reality − Expectations" is not real maths, but a one-line equation makes an argument instantly memorable and easy to share.

waitbutwhy.com/2013/09/why-generation-y-yuppies-are-unhappy.html

## 02

FOCUS · WORK | 8 MIN READ

### "The Top Idea in Your Mind" by Paul Graham

**In one line:** whatever your mind drifts to in the shower is your real priority, so make sure it's something worth thinking about.

Graham noticed that most people have one idea that their thoughts return to whenever they are free, on a walk, in the bath, before sleep. That idea gets your best unconscious thinking. The trap, he says, is that it is often not your work or your dream but an argument with someone or a worry about money. His fix: avoid disputes where you can, be cautious about chasing money for its own sake, and protect that mental space like a garden. A short read that will make you notice where your mind goes on this holiday.

**STEAL THIS TRICK**

**Start from a moment everyone knows.** Opening with "the shower" lets every reader test the idea on themselves within seconds.

paulgraham.com/top.html

## 03

MONEY · INDIA | 10 MIN READ

### "The Stock Markets Index" by Zerodha Varsity

**In one line:** the Sensex and Nifty are a kind of thermometer that tells you, in one number, how the whole market is feeling.

We print the Sensex and Nifty every morning on page 1. This chapter, next in Varsity's beginner series after yesterday's "The Stock Markets", explains what they are: a basket of large companies, chosen to represent the economy, combined into a single number that rises and falls with them. You'll learn why the Sensex has 30 companies and the Nifty 50, why bigger companies count for more, and how traders use the index to judge the mood or to protect their money. After this, "Sensex up 107 points" will mean something.

**STEAL THIS TRICK**

**Explain with an everyday object.** Calling an index a thermometer means a reader who knows nothing about shares can still picture exactly what it does.

zerodha.com/varsity/chapter/the-stock-markets-index

Read times are rough estimates. Links go to the original publishers.

# The Book Review

TODAY: HISTORY




★★★★★

**Genre:** History
**First published:** 2007
**Length:** about 900 pages
**Style:** storytelling, fair, full of people
**Read it:** a chapter a night, for a month

REVIEW · *INDIA AFTER GANDHI: THE HISTORY OF THE WORLD'S LARGEST DEMOCRACY*

## The story of how a country that experts said would fall apart became the world's largest democracy instead

In 1947 many foreign observers gave newly free India a few years at most. It was too poor, too divided by language, religion and caste, and too big, they said, to hold together as one democracy. Ramachandra Guha's book is the story of how it did, told from Independence through the decades that followed.

Guha, a historian from Bengaluru who also writes beautifully about cricket, tells it through people as much as events. You meet Vallabhbhai Patel and V. P. Menon persuading hundreds of princely states to join India; B. R. Ambedkar shaping the Constitution; Nehru and the first general election of 1951–52, when millions voted for the first time using party symbols because so many could not read. Later chapters cover the wars, the Emergency, the reforms of 1991 and the rise of new political forces.

It is long, and you don't have to read it in order. But it's never dry: Guha writes like a storyteller, quotes the people who were there, and is fair to every side. Most of us learned our country's freedom struggle at school, and very little about what came after. This book fills that gap.

*"We, the people of India..."*

The first words of the Constitution, adopted in 1949. Its making, by people who disagreed fiercely, is one of the best stories in the book.

THREE THINGS THIS BOOK TEACHES

**1**

### Unity was built, not given

Joining hundreds of princely states into one India took patient bargaining, and sometimes force. It was never inevitable.

**2**

### Votes before literacy

India gave every adult the vote from the very first election, long before most could read, and the bet largely paid off.

**3**

### Democracy is daily work

Institutions like courts, the press and the Election Commission keep it alive. The Emergency shows how quickly it can wobble.

**READ IT IF YOU…**

- know the freedom struggle but not what came after 1947
- enjoyed *Sapiens* (reviewed on 5 November) and want a closer, Indian story
- like history told through people, not dates

**LIKED IT? READ NEXT**

- *The Discovery of India* by Jawaharlal Nehru
- *Midnight's Children* by Salman Rushdie, the same years as fiction
- *A Corner of a Foreign Field* by Ramachandra Guha, on Indian cricket

The quote is from the Preamble to the Constitution of India. An updated edition of the book appeared in 2017.

# Puzzles & Games

EIGHT BRAIN GAMES · EASY → HARD · ANSWERS ON PAGE 11

1 · EASY · WORDS

## The sour helper

Unscramble these letters to find a kitchen liquid that helps lift stains (page 11).

G R A V E N I

2 · EASY · NUMBERS

## What comes next?

Look closely: these numbers have something in common.

1 4 9 16 25 ?

3 · MEDIUM · WORDS

## From cold to warm

Change one letter at a time to turn COLD into WARM. Every step must be a real word.

COLD → ? → ? → ? → WARM

4 · MEDIUM · LOGIC

## The sweet shop

2 boxes of kaju katli and 3 boxes of laddoos cost ₹1,300. One box of each costs ₹550. What does one box of kaju katli cost?

5 · MEDIUM · GRID

## Mini Sudoku

Fill in the grid so every row, column and 2×2 box has 1, 2, 3 and 4.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 2 |
| | 3 | | |
| | | 1 | |
| 4 | | | |

6 · MEDIUM · TODAY'S NEWS

## The Sensex grows up

The Sensex started life at 100 points (its base year is 1978–79). It closed on Monday at about 81,107. Roughly how many times bigger is it now? (Round to the nearest whole number.)

7 · HARD · NUMBERS

## The clock's angle

What is the smaller angle between the hour hand and the minute hand of a clock at exactly 7:20?

8 · HARD · WORDPLAY

## Read the picture

What common phrase does this show?

MIND
MATTER

Hint: it's how you push through a hard workout.

# Facts, Figures & Takes

THINGS TO SAY OVER HOLIDAY CHAI

**$4.1 bn**

Foreign money into Indian shares so far in November, the most in any month since September 2024 (page 1).

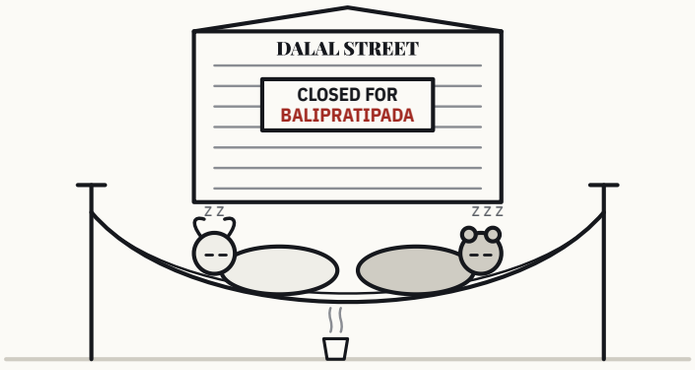
**13,629 ft**

The height at which an IAF IL-76 landed at Nyoma in Ladakh, higher than Leh (page 4).

**3**

Leaders Trump hopes to seat at one table in Shenzhen: himself, Xi and Putin (page 3).

POCKET CARTOON




*"One day a year, the bull and the bear agree on something."*

THE TAKE · OUR OPINION

## A photo opportunity is still an opportunity

Experts are sceptical that Trump, Xi and Putin will agree on much in Shenzhen next week. One analyst called the meeting "no more than a photo opportunity". They may well be right: the three disagree on Iran, Ukraine and trade, and none has promised anything.

But history suggests that leaders sitting in the same room matters, even when the first meeting achieves little. Talks create deadlines, staff build working relationships, and walking away becomes harder once cameras have seen you shake hands. For a country like India, which buys oil from the Gulf, trades with China and is a friend of both America and Russia, the alternative to awkward meetings is far worse.

**Our view:** don't expect a peace deal by 19 November. Do expect the oil price to move with every headline, and hope the handshake leads to a second meeting.

This is the Gazette's opinion.

### MONEY IDEA OF THE DAY: THE 72 RULE

Want to know how long it takes money to double? Divide 72 by the yearly return. At 8% a year, 72 ÷ 8 = about **9 years**; at 12%, about 6. It's a rough rule, not exact, but it shows why starting early matters so much: two extra doublings over a working life can mean four times the money.

DID YOU KNOW?

### A king who comes home

Balipratipada celebrates the legendary King Bali, who is said to return to visit his people each year. Kerala's Onam honours the same king, as Mahabali.

### Born at 100 and 1,000

The Sensex's base value is 100 (base year 1978–79). The Nifty began at 1,000, with its base date in November 1995.

### A village became a megacity

Shenzhen, host of next week's APEC summit, was a small town until China made it a special economic zone in 1980. Today it is home to millions.

### Why tea stains

Tea and coffee contain tannins, the plant compounds that make them taste slightly dry and that cling to cloth fibres (page 11).

### Thin air, faster landing

Planes landing at high airfields must touch down at a higher ground speed, because thin air gives the wings less lift (page 4).

### Symbols on the ballot

India's first general election in 1951–52 used party symbols so voters who could not read could still choose (page 7).

Figures from pages 1–4. Facts from standard reference works, the NSE and BSE.

# Ten Words for Today

LEARN THEM, THEN USE ONE BEFORE DINNER

1 **Ostentatious** adj. · os-ten-TAY-shus
Showy; designed to impress people with wealth.
*"The wedding was ostentatious, with three bands and a horse."*

2 **Nuance** noun · NYOO-ahns
A small, subtle difference in meaning or feeling.
*"Good history captures the nuance of every side."*

3 **Erudite** adj. · ER-yoo-dite
Having or showing great knowledge from study.
*"Guha is erudite, yet never boring."*

4 **Fortuitous** adj. · for-TYOO-ih-tus
Happening by lucky chance.
*"A holiday right after a big rally felt fortuitous."*

5 **Venerable** adj. · VEN-er-uh-bul
Respected because of age, wisdom or long history.
*"The venerable BSE is Asia's oldest stock exchange."*

6 **Cajole** verb · kuh-JOHL
To persuade someone gently, by flattery or coaxing.
*"Diplomats will try to cajole Iran back to the table."*

7 **Brevity** noun · BREV-ih-tee
The quality of being short and to the point.
*"Paul Graham's essays are loved for their brevity."*

8 **Zealous** adj. · ZEL-us
Full of great energy and enthusiasm for a cause.
*"Zealous fans were awake at 7:30 for the ODI."*

9 **Quintessential** adj. · kwin-tih-SEN-shul
The most perfect or typical example of something.
*"Vada pav is the quintessential Mumbai snack."*

10 **Vindicate** verb · VIN-dih-kate
To prove that someone was right or blameless.
*"India's democracy vindicated the leaders who believed in it."*

## TODAY'S CHALLENGE

Use **quintessential** to describe your favourite holiday ritual, in a message to a friend today.

# Skill of the Day

HOME · ABOUT 15 MINUTES · DIFFICULTY: EASY

LAUNDRY · AS PROMISED YESTERDAY

# How to get a tea or coffee stain out of a shirt

*Spilled your chai during Diwali? Don't panic, and don't rub. With cold water, a little liquid detergent and some patience, most fresh stains come out completely.*

**WHAT YOU'LL NEED**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Cold water and a clean white cloth or tissue | Liquid detergent or dishwashing liquid | White vinegar (for stubborn stains) | An old soft toothbrush (optional) |

## 1 Act fast, blot, don't rub

Press a clean cloth on the stain to soak up as much liquid as you can. **Rubbing spreads the stain** and pushes it deeper into the fibres.

## 2 Flush from the back with cold water

Turn the shirt inside out and hold the stain under a cold tap. Water from behind pushes the stain **out** of the cloth, not through it. Avoid hot water: milky chai has proteins that heat can "cook" into the fabric.

## 3 Dab on detergent

Put a few drops of liquid detergent or dish soap on the stain. Work it in gently with your fingertip or a soft toothbrush, in small circles from the outside in. Leave it for **5–10 minutes**.

## 4 Rinse and check

Rinse again with cold water. If a brown shadow remains, mix one part white vinegar with two parts cold water, dab it on, wait 10 minutes and rinse.

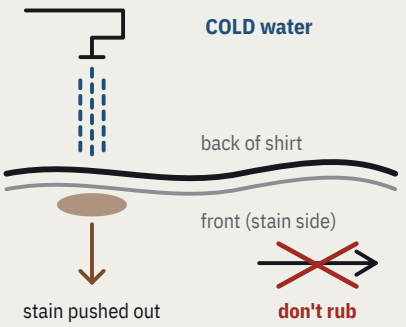
## 5 Wash as normal

Wash the shirt by hand or machine at the temperature on its care label.

## 6 Check before you dry

Look at the spot in daylight **before** ironing or tumble-drying. Heat sets stains permanently, so if any mark remains, repeat steps 3–4 first.

### FLUSH FROM BEHIND




### ⚠ SAFETY

- **Never mix bleach with vinegar or ammonia**: the combination releases toxic gas.
- Test vinegar or any cleaner on a hidden spot (inside a seam) first, especially on silk, wool or coloured fabric.
- Silk, wool and "dry clean only" clothes: blot, then take them to a professional.

### PRO TIP

Caught out at a restaurant? Blot, then dab with cold soda water or plain water and a napkin. It keeps the stain from drying until you get home.

**Tomorrow's skill:** how to tie a bowline, the sailor's knot that never slips and is easy to untie.

**PUZZLE ANSWERS (PAGE 8) · TURN THE PAPER UPSIDE DOWN**

1. VINEGAR · 2. 36 (they are square numbers: $1^2$, $2^2$, … $6^2$) · 3. COLD → CORD → CARD → WARD → WARM · 4. ₹350 (laddoo box ₹200: 2 × 350 + 3 × 200 = 1,300) · 5. Rows: 1 4 3 2 / 2 3 4 1 / 3 2 1 4 / 4 1 2 3 · 6. About 811 times (81,107 ÷ 100) · 7. 100° (hour hand at 220°, minute hand at 120°) · 8. MIND OVER MATTER